



Syllabus(Intermediate)

Level 1: Mastering Fundamentals (4 Months)

Objective: Strengthen tactical, strategic, and endgame understanding with an introduction to structured planning.

Week 1-3: Tactical Brilliance

- Tactical Review — Forks, Pins, Skewers (Reinforcement from beginner level).
- Discovered attacks and Double checks (Advanced puzzles and practice).
- Deflection, Clearance and Decoy tactics (How to force the opponent's hand).
- Puzzle-solving session (Interactive challenge puzzles).

Week 4-8: Positional Play

- Pawn structures (Isolated pawns, doubled pawns, passed pawns, backward pawns).
- Weak and strong squares (How to recognize and use them).
- Piece activity (How to place your pieces on the best squares).
- Practical Play — Analyze games focusing on pawn structure and piece activity.

Week 9-12: Opening Fundamentals (Repertoire Building)

- Key principles of modern openings (The role of pawn breaks).
- Basic opening repertoire (1.e4 and 1.d4 systems for White, 1...e5 & 1...d5 for Black).
- Avoiding opening traps (e.g., Fried Liver Attack, Stafford Gambit traps).
- Practice Play — Students play rapid games focusing on opening principles.

Weeks 13-16: Endgame Essentials

- Checkmate with Double Bishops.
- Pawn endgames (Mined Squares, Triangulation, Reti's Idea).
- Rook vs. pawn endgames (Lucena and Philidor positions).
- Play and Test — Practical endgame practice session.



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Level 2: Strategic Thinking and Complex Tactics (4 Months)

Objective: Develop deeper understanding of positional play, strategy, and advanced tactics.

Weeks 1-2: Complex Tactics

- Intermediate combinations (Combining tactics — forks + skewers, pins + discovery).
- Interference and blocking tactics (Cutting off enemy lines).
- Zwischenzug (Intermediate moves) — How to surprise your opponent.

Week 3-4: Various Patterns of Checkmate

- The See-Saw, Taimanov's Knight Check, The Petrosian Draw, Lolli's Mates, Anderssen's Mate
- Mate in 3,4 & 5 moves, Puzzle-solving competition (Students compete in solving interactive puzzles).

Week 5-9: Advanced Positional Play & Middlegame Strategy

- Various Pawn Structure: How to handle pawn breaks (when and how to push pawns).
- Practice Game Review — Students analyze their own games focusing on pawn play.
- Plan creation — How to make a plan in the middlegame.
- How to defend effectively (Prophylactic moves, finding your opponent's threats).
- Practical Play — Students play rapid games focusing on attacking and defensive play.

Week 10-14: Advanced Endgames

- Complete Knight Endgames
- Key Rook endgames (Vancura Position, Max Karstedt, Cheron, Grigoriev, Levenfish, Kling & Horwitz).
- Minor piece endgames (Bishop vs. Knight endgames/How to exploit the strengths of each piece).
- Practical endgame exercises (Students play out common endgame positions).

Week 15-16: Classical Game Study

- Know The World Champions: 1,2,3.
- Solving the Puzzles from their games.



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Level 3: Practical Play and Tournament Preparation (4 Months)

Objective: Prepare students for tournament play with practical strategies, time management, and mindset development.

Weeks 1-2: Advanced Opening Theory

- Reinforcing the student's personal repertoire (practical review of White and Black systems).
- Gambits and Counter-Gambits (Learn and defend against common gambits).
- Recognizing and exploiting opening inaccuracies.
- Opening preparation for tournaments — how to prepare specific lines for specific opponents.

Weeks 3-6: Tournament Tactics

- Annihilation of Defence, Demolition of Pawn Structure.
- Importance of prophylactic thinking (anticipating your opponent's threats).
- How to turn tactical advantages into wins (Convert an advantage).
- Time pressure management (Practical techniques for blitz/rapid games).
- Mini-tournament — Students play 5+3 rapid games to apply concepts.

Weeks 7-11: Board-Visualization & Various Mating Patterns

- Board-Visualization and introduction to Blind-Fold Calculation
- Legall's Mate, The Greek Gift, The Bishop Sacrifice on f7, The Bxh6 Sacrifice, Knight Sacrifices on f7 & e6, The Fischer Trap.
- Mate in 6 & 7 Moves.
- Practical Tactical exercises (Students play out common Tactical positions).

Weeks 12-16: Endgame Expertise & Tournament Preparation and Game Analysis

- Pawn Endgames(Complete), Basic Rook Endgames(Complete).
- Bishop Endgame(Same coloured/Opposite coloured), Good Bishop & Bad Bishop, Endgame competition — Students are given endgame positions to solve and win.
- Understanding psychological preparation (handling pressure and nerves), Tournament rules and etiquette, How to analyze your own games (post-game analysis techniques).
- Simulated tournament — Students play in a structured format with specific time control.

Assessment and Testing

1. Monthly Tests:

- Tactical puzzles.
- Opening positions — Students have to find the best move.
- Practical endgame positions (students must convert to a win or draw).

2. Quarterly Exams (at the end of each level):

- Students play two tournament-style games (with 20+5 time control) to apply all concepts learned.
- Students must solve a batch of tactics (graded for accuracy).
- Feedback is provided on areas of improvement.

Tools & Resources

- **Chess Software:** Lichess, Chess.com (for online games, puzzles, and analysis).
- **Books:**
 - *Winning Chess Tactics* by Yasser Seirawan (tactics).
 - *Silman's Complete Endgame Course* by Jeremy Silman (endgames).
 - *How to Reassess Your Chess* by Jeremy Silman (strategy).

Key Features

- **Holistic Approach:** Balance between tactics, strategy, endgames, and practical play.
- **Interactive Play:** Each level involves game play, puzzle solving, and tournament-like experiences.
- **Strong Feedback:** Students receive feedback after game reviews and tests.
- **Tournament-Ready:** Students are equipped with preparation strategies for local, online, and FIDE tournaments.

This intermediate syllabus ensures students experience all phases of the game — **opening, middlegame, and endgame**. It also builds mental toughness, game analysis skills, and tournament readiness. Let me know if you'd like any adjustments or specific focus areas.

"Our curriculum and course structure have been meticulously designed by **FIDE MASTER Joydeep Dutta**, an experienced chess coach with a peak FIDE rating of 2355. With over a decade of coaching expertise and a proven track record of nurturing titled players, FM Joydeep Dutta has crafted a step-by-step learning approach tailored to ensure systematic growth for beginners, intermediate, and advanced students alike."